Number of ACO Assigned Beneficiaries by County PUF Data Dictionary

Term Name	Variable Name	Definition	Footnotes
Year	Year	Calendar year (CY) for which assigned beneficiaries are determined.	For calendar year 2019, two performance years were present in the Shared Saving Program. Each performance year has a separate data file and both will list 2019 for the Year field. ACOs can be in both performance years with differing beneficiary population across counties.
ACO ID	ACO_ID	Unencrypted ACO identifier. This identifier can be linked to the encrypted ACO identifier used for prior performance years. (Refer to Notes.)	
State name	State_Name	State name	
County name	County_Name	County name	
State ID	State_ID	Social Security Administration (SSA) state code. This code should always include two numeric characters, though leading zeros may be dropped when opening the files in some programs (e.g. a value of “01” may appear as “1”).	
County ID	County_ID	SSA county code. This code should always include three numeric characters, though leading zeros may be dropped when opening the files in some programs (e.g. a value of “001” may appear as “1”).	
ESRD assigned beneficiary person years	AB_Psn_Yrs_ESRD	Number of assigned beneficiaries with ESRD enrollment type in the county in the report period, adjusted for the total number of months that each beneficiary was classified as ESRD.	(.) = Missing (county has no assigned beneficiaries with this enrollment type) (*) = Suppressed (county has between 1 and 10 total assigned beneficiaries or county was selected for complementary suppression; see Notes for more information)
DISABLED assigned beneficiary person years	AB_Psn_Yrs_DIS	Number of assigned beneficiaries with DISABLED enrollment type in the county in the report period, adjusted for the total number of months that each beneficiary was classified as DISABLED.	(.) = Missing (county has no assigned beneficiaries with this enrollment type) (*) = Suppressed (county has between 1 and 10 total assigned beneficiaries or county was selected for complementary suppression; see Notes for more information)

Term Name	Variable Name	Definition	Footnotes
AGED/DUAL assigned beneficiary person years	AB_Psn_Yrs_AGDU	Number of assigned beneficiaries with AGED/DUAL enrollment type in the county in the report period, adjusted for the total number of months that each beneficiary was classified as AGED/DUAL.	(.) = Missing (county has no assigned beneficiaries with this enrollment type) (*) = Suppressed (county has between 1 and 10 total assigned beneficiaries or county was selected for complementary suppression; see Notes for more information)
AGED/NON-DUAL assigned beneficiary person years	AB_Psn_Yrs_AGND	Number of assigned beneficiaries with AGED/NON-DUAL enrollment type in the county in the report period, adjusted for the total number of months that each beneficiary was classified as AGED/NON-DUAL.	(.) = Missing (county has no assigned beneficiaries with this enrollment type) (*) = Suppressed (county has between 1 and 10 total assigned beneficiaries or county was selected for complementary suppression; see Notes for more information)
Total assigned beneficiary person years	Tot_AB_Psn_Yrs	Total number of assigned beneficiaries in the county in the report period, adjusted for the total number of months that each beneficiary was classified as one of the four enrollment types.	(*) = Suppressed (county has between 1 and 10 total assigned beneficiaries or county was selected for complementary suppression; see Notes for more information)
Total assigned beneficiaries	Tot_AB	Total number of assigned beneficiaries in the county in the report period.	(*) = Suppressed (county has between 1 and 10 total assigned beneficiaries or county was selected for complementary suppression; see Notes for more information)

Parameters

File year	File Name	Number of ACOs	Assignment Window	Report Period	Voluntary Alignment End Date	Claims Run-Out
2021	Number_Of_ACO_Assigned_Beneficiaries_by_County_PUF_2021_01_01.csv	475	Preliminary Prospective: 01/01/2021 - 12/31/2021	All ACOs: 01/01/2021 - 12/31/2021	All ACOs: 09/30/2020	3 months
2020	Number_Of_ACO_Assigned_Beneficiaries_by_County_PUF_2020_01_01.csv	513	Prospective: 10/01/2019 - 09/30/2020	All ACOs: 01/01/2020 - 12/31/2020	All ACOs: 09/30/2019	3 months
2019A	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2019A.csv	205	Preliminary Prospective: 01/01/2020 - 12/31/2020	All ACOs: 01/01/2019 - 12/31/2019	All ACOs: 4/30/2019	3 months
2019	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2019.csv	475	Prospective: 10/01/2018 - 09/30/2019	All ACOs: 01/01/2019 - 12/31/2019	All ACOs: 10/31/2018	3 months
2018	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2018.csv	548	Preliminary Prospective: 01/01/2019 - 12/31/2019	All ACOs: 01/01/2018 - 12/31/2018	All ACOs: 10/31/2017	3 months
2017	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2017.csv	472	Prospective: 10/01/2017 - 09/30/2018	All ACOs: 01/01/2017 - 12/31/2017	Not applicable	3 months
2016	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2016.csv	432	Preliminary Prospective: 01/01/2019 - 12/31/2019	All ACOs: 01/01/2016 - 12/31/2016	Not applicable	3 months
2015	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2014.csv	333	Prospective: 10/01/2017 - 09/30/2018	01/01/2014 - 12/31/2014	Not applicable	3 months
2014	ACO.SSP.COUNTY.ASSIGNED.PUF.2015.csv	392	Preliminary Prospective: 01/01/2018 - 12/31/2018	01/01/2015 - 12/31/2015	Not applicable	3 months

Notes

1. To link unencrypted ACO identifiers with encrypted identifiers used for prior performance years, reference:
ACO ID Crosswalk
2. Assigned beneficiary person-year counts are based on certified ACO Participant Lists for the performance year (PY) associated with the file year and based on the assignment methodology and definition of dual eligible beneficiaries in effect for that performance year.
3. For information on assignment methodology, reference:
Medicare Shared Savings Program Guidance & Specifications
4. For definitions of primary care services, reference:
Medicare Shared Savings Program Statutes & Regulations
5. For definitions of providers, reference:
Medicare Shared Savings Program Statutes & Regulations
6. All cells associated with between 1 and 10 beneficiaries are automatically suppressed (primary suppression). Additional cells associated with either 11 or more beneficiaries or associated with missing values (i.e. zero beneficiaries) are suppressed as necessary to ensure the data are de-identified in compliance with HIPAA privacy rules (complementary suppression). In general, additional cells are suppressed as necessary to ensure that within a given column for a given ACO either no cells or at least two cells are suppressed, and that among the four enrollment type columns within a given row, either no cells or at least two cells are suppressed. Values in suppressed cells are set equal to "*".
7. For calendar year 2019, two performance years were present in the Shared Saving Program. Each performance year has a separate data file and both will list 2019 for the Year field. ACOs can be in both performance years with differing beneficiary population across counties.
8. Person year variables for the applicable file years have been adjusted to exclude months associated with episodes of care for treatment of COVID-19. For more information on these adjustments, reference:
Medicare Shared Savings Program Guidance & Specifications